

Mekra Catholic Wiki — User Guide

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Mekra Catholic Wiki Project

2026

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A bilingual Amharic + English knowledge companion for Ethiopian Catholic priests, catechists, and the faithful.

What is the Mekra Wiki?

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The Mekra Catholic Wiki is a digital Amharic-first knowledge base built on the foundation of the **Catholic Compendium of the Catechism** — the same compendium published by the Ethiopian Catholic Bishops' Conference in 2005 (ISBN 9966-08-114-3).

It brings together:

- **The full Compendium of the Catechism** (598 Q&As in clean Amharic)
- **The complete Amharic Bible** (Emmaus Catholic Edition, 73 books)
- **All common Catholic prayers in Amharic** (Sign of the Cross, ሰላም ለንቺ ማርያም, Angelus, Te Deum, Veni Creator, the Rosary, and ~20 more)
- **Teaching syntheses on every major Catholic doctrine** — baptism, the Eucharist, the sacraments, the moral life, prayer
- **Comparative pages** showing how Catholic teaching aligns with and differs from Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo (EOTC), Eastern Orthodox, and Protestant positions
- **Biographies** of Ethiopian saints (አባ ሰላማ, ቅዱስ ያሴድ, ተክለ ሃይማኖት, ገብረ መንፈስ ቅዱስ) and universal Church Fathers (Augustine, Jerome, Chrysostom, and others)
- **Liturgical calendar** — feast days, fasting periods, lectionary

- **An AI assistant** that can answer questions in Amharic, cite its sources, and remember every conversation so the wiki grows over time

Every answer the AI gives is grounded in real, verifiable Amharic Catholic sources — never invented, never paraphrased from memory.

Who is this for?

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- **ካህናት (Priests)** — for homily preparation, catechesis, answering parishioner questions, and looking up the official Amharic phrasing of teachings and prayers.
 - **የሃይማኖት መምህራን (Catechists)** — for preparing lessons in confirmation, marriage, baptism, and adult faith formation.
 - **ምእመናን (Faithful)** — for personal study, devotion, understanding the faith, and finding answers in your own language.
 - **ተማሪዎች (Students)** — seminarians, theology students, researchers studying Ethiopian Catholic theology.
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Top 10 Ways to Use the Wiki

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1. Ask Doctrinal Questions in Amharic

“የቅመቅት ምን ማለት ነው?” (“What is baptism?”)

“ምሥጢረ ቁርባን ለምን አስፈላጊ ነው?” (“Why is the Eucharist necessary?”)

The AI will quote directly from the Compendium (Q&As 252–294 for baptism, 271–294 for the Eucharist), in Amharic, with citations.

2. Find a Prayer in Authentic Amharic

“ከላም ላንቺ ማርያምን አሳዳኝ” (“Show me the Hail Mary”)

“መቄጸሪያ እንዴት እጸልያለሁ?” (“How do I pray the Rosary?”)

You get the exact wording used by the Ethiopian Catholic Church — not a translation guess, but the prayer as it was published.

3. Compare Catholic ↔ Ethiopian Orthodox Teaching

“ካቶሊክ እና የተዋህዶ ቤተክርስቲያን በምሥጢረ ቁርባን ላይ የሚለያዩት እንዴት ነው?”
 (“How do Catholics and EOTC differ on the Eucharist?”)

The AI shows both perspectives respectfully — explains miaphysitism, the Filioque, married priesthood, the role of the Pope, fasting differences, the use of the Ge’ez liturgy, and more.

4. Look Up Bible Verses

“ማቴዎስ 5:3–12 ምን ይላል?” (“What does Matthew 5:3–12 say?”)
 “ሮሜ 6 ምዕራፍ አሳኝ?” (“Show me Romans chapter 6”)

The AI pulls the Amharic text from the Emmaus Catholic Edition database and quotes it directly, with the book and verse citation.

5. Prepare for a Sacrament

“የምቀት ለማድረግ ምን ማወቅ አለብኝ?” (“What do I need to know for a baptism?”)
 “ለመጋባት ምን አስፈላጊ ነው?” (“What is required for marriage?”)
 “ኩዛዜ እንዴት እከውናለሁ?” (“How do I make a confession?”)

The AI walks you through the doctrine, the rite, the questions a parishioner might ask, and the Amharic prayers used.

6. Define a Theological Term

“ጸጋ ምንድን ነው?” (“What is grace?”)
 “ኪዳን ምን ማለት ነው?” (“What does covenant mean?”)

The AI gives the Amharic term, its Ge’ez equivalent, the Greek and Latin originals, biblical examples, and how Catholic doctrine uses the term.

7. Plan for a Feast Day or Liturgical Season

“በዐቢይ ጾም ጊዜ ምን ላድርግ?” (“What should I do during Lent?”)
 “መስቀል ለምን ይከበራል?” (“Why is the Cross feast celebrated?”)
 “የምቀት በዓል መቼ ነው?” (“When is the Timket feast?”)

You get the date in the Ethiopian calendar, the readings, the customs, the Amharic prayers, and the spiritual meaning.

8. Defend the Faith (Apologetics)

“ከቶሊኮች ለምን ለቅዱሳን ይጸልያሉ?” (“Why do Catholics pray to saints?”)

“ማርያም ለምን አምልኳለች?” (“Is Mary worshipped?”)

“ለምን አንድ የሐዋርያት ቤተክርስቲያን አንተኛ ናት?” (“Why is there one Apostolic Church?”)

The AI gives the answer with Scripture, the Compendium, and Ethiopian context — designed to help you respond confidently to common challenges.

9. Learn About a Saint or Church Father

“አባ ሰላማ ማን ነበር?” (“Who was Abba Selama?”)

“ቅዱስ ያራድ ምን አስተማረ?” (“What did Saint Yared teach?”)

“ቅዱስ ዮሐንስ አፈወርቅ ስለ ቂርባን ምን አለ?” (“What did John Chrysostom say about the Eucharist?”)

Get biographies, key writings, and how each saint shaped the faith — with special depth for Ethiopian saints.

10. Let the Wiki Compound Over Time

Every substantial question you ask is filed permanently.

The next priest, catechist, or layperson who asks the same question can read the previous answer instantly. Each session makes the wiki smarter and faster for the entire Ethiopian Catholic community.

How the AI Gets It Right

AI እንዴት ትክክለኛውን ይሰጣል?

Three foundations make this trustworthy:

Foundation 1 — Real Sources

Every answer cites a real source:

- **Compendium answers** cite the specific Q-number from the digital edition extracted from the publisher's .pages source.
- **Bible verses** come from the Amharic Emmaus Catholic Edition database (73 books, 1,329 chapters).
- **Prayers and formulas** come from the Compendium's appendix in Ethiopian Catholic Bishops' Conference publication.
- **Teaching pages** are syntheses written from the Compendium with full citation back to the Q-numbers.

Foundation 2 — Amharic Integrity

- Archaic Amharic letters (ሠ, ሐ, ጐ, ጸ, ፀ, ፊ) are preserved exactly as the Church publishes them. Nothing is “modernized.”
- Ethiopic punctuation (፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡) is used, not Latin punctuation.
- Bilingual glosses are provided for theological terms (e.g., ቅጥፍ / *Baptism*).

Foundation 3 — No Invented Answers

If the AI doesn't know something with confidence, it says so. It will never make up a Q number, a verse, or a citation. When something is uncertain, it gets flagged and recorded so it can be verified.

How to Ask Good Questions

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The AI understands both Amharic and English. You can mix them.

Best practices:

- **Ask in the language you want the answer in.** Amharic question → Amharic answer. English question → English answer.
- **Be specific when possible.** “What does the Compendium say about the Real Presence in the Eucharist?” is better than “Tell me about the Mass.”
- **You can ask for citations.** “Quote the exact wording from the Compendium” works.
- **You can ask follow-ups.** The AI remembers the context of the conversation.
- **Don't be afraid to disagree or push back.** If something seems wrong, ask the AI to verify against the source — that's how the wiki gets corrected and improved.

What's Inside (Numbers)

Resource	Count
Compendium Q&As (Amharic)	597
Common Catholic prayers (Amharic)	~24
Bible books (Amharic Emmaus Catholic Edition)	73
Teaching synthesis pages	50+
Saint and Church Father biographies	30+
Apologetics pages	10+
Comparative theology pages (Catholic ↔ EOTC ↔ Orthodox ↔ Protestant)	35+
Liturgical feast day pages	12+
Concept/glossary pages (Amharic ↔ Ge'ez ↔ Greek ↔ Latin)	30+

All of this is in Amharic first, with English support where helpful.

A Note for Priests

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This wiki was built to serve the Ethiopian Catholic Church.

It will never replace the wisdom of a confessor, the authority of the bishop, the discernment of a spiritual director, or the work of the Holy Spirit. It is a *tool* — a digital companion that puts the official teaching of the Church, in your own language, at your fingertips.

Use it for sermon preparation. Use it to answer the questions parishioners bring after Mass. Use it when a young person asks why we do things differently from the Orthodox neighbors. Use it when you want the exact wording of a prayer.

And when you find something it doesn't know, or something it got wrong — please tell us. Every correction makes the wiki more faithful for the next priest who opens it.

“እኢግዚአብሔር አምላክህን በፍጹም ልብህ፣ በፍጹም ነፍስህ በፍጹም ሐሳብህም ውደድ፡፡”

— ማቴዎስ 22፡37

Mekra Catholic Wiki — built with care for the Ethiopian Catholic Church.

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